Southampton Union Free School District

DUAL LANGUAGE PROGRAM

PARENT HANDBOOK

2026-27





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Grades Kindergarten Through Twelve

Welcome to The Southampton Dual Language Program! This handbook is designed to serve as a comprehensive guide for families, outlining our program's vision, instructional model, curriculum, assessments, and the important role families play in supporting bilingualism, biliteracy, and biculturalism.

Program Vision and Goals

Our Dual Language program values and celebrates the unique strengths of our community while fostering the curiosity, joy, and wonder of our students. The partnership between Southampton's families and staff is central to sustaining our school's mission and vision. This Program is built on the belief that learning in two languages is a powerful asset. Through high-quality instruction in both English and Spanish, students develop strong academic skills while also building cultural understanding and global awareness.

Our core goals are to support students in becoming:

- Bilingual – able to communicate effectively in English and Spanish
- Biliterate – able to read, write, and think critically in both languages
- Bicultural – able to appreciate, respect, and navigate multiple cultures

Students in the program learn rigorous academic content while developing confidence, flexibility, and pride in their linguistic and cultural identities.

International Spanish Academy

Southampton is an International Spanish Academy (ISA) designated district and its Spanish program meets the standards established by Spain´s Ministry of Education, Culture and Sport. The ISA program offers students a comprehensive education that will develop skills and abilities through a total immersion in the Spanish language and culture, and also through the use of an instructional model that integrates content, communication, knowledge and culture. Students receive ISA diplomas in Fourth Grade after consistent participation throughout elementary school, starting in Kindergarten. Students also receive an ISA diploma after completing ISA courses beginning fifth grade through eighth grade consecutively. Twelfth grade students will receive an ISA diploma after completing ISA courses from ninth through twelfth grade consecutively. Students who have not completed consecutive years in the ISA program will receive a local certificate.

Benefits of a Dual Language Program

Benefits for English Proficient students, more than twenty years of research have shown:

- English-Proficient students develop proficiency in two languages
- English-proficient students score as well or better than their monolingual peers on standardized tests of math and English Language Arts.
- English-proficient students develop a positive sense of self and demonstrate positive cross-cultural attitudes and behaviors
- Benefits for English Language Learners, more than forty years of research has shown:
- English Language Learners (ELL) who receive Spanish language instruction were able to catch up to or surpass the achievement levels of English proficient peers who were educated in English-only mainstream classrooms. These results were found regardless of the student's socioeconomic background. (Thomas & Collier, 2002)
- English learners who participated in programs that provided extended instruction in the native language (dual language programs) outperformed students who received short-term instruction through their native language (transitional bilingual education).

The Process of Language Acquisition

Language acquisition is the process of developing the ability to understand a language and use it to communicate within societal norms. It's the process of going from a wordless individual into somebody who can articulate their thoughts coherently and without reservation.

We learn language through two modalities. Basic Interpersonal Communication Skills (BICS) which involves language skills needed for everyday language. BICS are personal, social language with clear and concrete contexts such as "Can I go to the bathroom, do you want to play, I'm hungry" etc. Language evolves into Cognitive Academic Language Proficiency Skills (CALPS)which involves cognitive development, academic conversations, reasoning, problem solving, analysis, and synthesis, such as understanding core subjects and abstract concepts. You learn a second language the same way you learn a first language. It is a process that requires time usually taking from up to 7 years to develop. Language development is based on motivation and practice. Proficiency in the first language serves as a platform where linguistic information is transferred from the native language to make sense of the second language. (Smith, Frank, Cummins, Jim)

Language Allocation- Southampton Elementary School Model

Our Elementary School program follows a 60/40 language allocation model:

- 60% of the instructional week is taught in English
- 40% of the instructional week is taught in Spanish

This model is designed to ensure strong development in English while intentionally supporting Spanish language growth. Language allocation is carefully planned across content areas to maximize transfer of skills between languages.

Elementary (K-4) Curriculum Overview

English Language Arts (ELA): English Language Arts is taught using **Magnetic Literacy**, a comprehensive, research-based core reading program.

Magnetic Literacy includes:

- Foundational Skills (Grades K–2)
  - Phonological awareness, Phonics and word study, High-frequency words, and Early reading and spelling
- Integrated Literacy (Grades K–4)
  - Knowledge-building, Reading comprehension, Writing, Vocabulary development, and Speaking and listening

In addition, students participate in Support and Extend, a dedicated small-group instructional time. During Support and Extend, teachers:

- Provide targeted support based on student needs
- Offer enrichment and extension opportunities
- Differentiate instruction to help all students grow

Spanish Language Arts (SLA): Spanish Language Arts is taught using **Mosaico Lectoescritura**, the sister program to Magnetic Literacy.

Mosaico Lectoescritura includes:

- Foundational Skills in Spanish (Grades K–2)
  - Phonological awareness in Spanish, Phonics aligned to Spanish orthography, Word reading and spelling
- Integrated Literacy (Grades K–4)
  - Knowledge-building, Reading comprehension, Writing, Vocabulary development, and Oral language

Integrated Literacy Language Rotation

- Integrated Literacy instruction alternates between English and Spanish
- 50% of Integrated Literacy instruction is in English and 50% is in Spanish
- This intentional rotation helps students make connections across languages and strengthens biliteracy development

Mathematics (K-4): Mathematics is taught using i-Ready Classroom Mathematics and is instructed in English.

This curriculum:

- Emphasizes conceptual understanding, Builds strong problem-solving skills, Provides opportunities for practice and discussion, and Aligns with grade-level standards

Although math instruction is in English, students benefit from the language skills and academic strategies they develop across both languages.

S.T.E.A.M. - Science, Technology, Engineering, Art, and Mathematics: STEAM is taught in English for all students. The teacher offers translanguaging for students with limited English proficiency. Translanguaging is the ability to move fluidly between languages and a pedagogical approach to teaching in which teachers support this ability. STEAM is taught using the Science21 Curriculum.

Social Studies: Social Studies is taught in Spanish in the Dual-Language program.
Instruction in these content areas emphasizes:

- Building academic vocabulary in Spanish
- Developing content knowledge through reading, discussion, and hands-on learning
- Making connections across languages
- Teachers use translanguaging strategically as needed to support comprehension, deepen understanding, and allow students to draw on their full linguistic repertoire while maintaining Spanish as the primary language of instruction

Conexiones

All students in grades K-4 receive Conexiones once per week, a Spanish class dedicated to exposing students to various Hispanic cultures around the world.

Dual Language Instructional Delivery - SES

	Foundational	ELA	SLA	Math	SS	STEAM	Conexiones
K	Eng/Spa	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	Eng	Span
K	Eng/Spa	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	Eng	Span
2	Eng/Spa	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	Eng	Span
3	NA	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	Eng	Span
4	NA	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	Eng	Span

Language Allocation-Southampton Intermediate School Model

The International Spanish Academy is a program-wide plan for promoting additive bilingualism and biliteracy that takes home language profiles into consideration. The International Spanish Academy (ISA) helps Southampton students achieve major world language milestones approximately two years earlier than students in a traditional World Language sequence. ISA students complete Checkpoint A in Grade 6 compared with the typical completion by Grade 8, and complete Checkpoint B in Grade 8 compared with the typical completion by Grade 10. In addition, many ISA students have the opportunity to earn the internationally recognized DELE certification while still in middle school, demonstrating advanced Spanish proficiency at an age when most students are still working toward Checkpoint B.

Assessment/Credential	ISA Students	Typical NYS Students
Checkpoint A	Grade 6	Grade 8
Checkpoint B	Grade 8	Grade 10
DELE (International Certification)	Grade 8	Optional, often high school or college level

Dual Language Instructional Delivery - SIS

GL	**ELA**	**Math**	**SS**	**Sci**	**WL**	**SLA**	**HLA**
5	Eng	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	N/A	Span
6	Eng	Eng	Span	Eng	Span	N/A	
7	Eng	Eng	Eng	Eng	Span	Span	Span
8	Eng	Eng	Eng	Eng	Span	Span	

5th Grade

ISA Spanish 1A (Grade 5)	**ISA Spanish 1A (Grade 5)**
ISA (International Spanish Academy) Spanish 1A is comparable to an advanced Spanish 1A course presented in an immersive Spanish-speaking environment, given the students prior exposure to the language in the Dual Language Program at SES. The New York State Learning Standards for World Languages guides the students to communicate effectively, interact with cultural competence, connect with other disciplines, make comparisons and interact with multilingual communities at home and around the world. Students can carry out interpretive, presentational and interpersonal presentations using thematic units based on the seasons, the world around them and relevant interconnected cultural explorations. Students can both read and write with a high level of fluency in the target language and use authentic texts from a variety of different cultures and contexts. The mechanics of spelling and vocabulary are connected to the thematic units of study through Word Study lists.	As part of the continuation of the dual language program from 4th grade, students in 5th grade social studies learn all about the Western Hemisphere. They will explore and understand the geography of the Western Hemisphere. Students will study the Native Americans of the Western Hemisphere, such as the Shinnecock, Aztec, Mayans and Inca civilizations. The European exploration to the Americas and the conquistadors are also closely studied. Students also learn about governmental, economic and social/cultural systems in relation to the United States, Canada, Mexico and Cuba. Students will partake in the same curriculum and scope and sequence as 5th grade English social studies, while being taught in Spanish. They will be integrating the content while practicing their reading, writing, listening and speaking skills in Spanish.

6th Grade

ISA Spanish 1B	ISA Social Studies 6th
Students will continue to enhance reading, writing, listening, and speaking proficiency in Spanish through engaging activities. Students will explore age-appropriate texts, such as short stories, poems, and informational articles, to develop their reading comprehension and critical thinking skills. Writing tasks will include personal narratives, descriptive pieces, and short essays, with a focus on sentence structure, vocabulary, and grammar. Listening and speaking exercises will encourage active participation, collaborative discussions, and oral presentations to boost confidence in using Spanish in everyday situations. The course also incorporates cultural elements to inspire an appreciation for the diverse traditions and perspectives within the Spanish-speaking world.	Students in 6th grade integrate content while practicing their reading, writing, listening and speaking skills in Spanish. 6th grade social studies is all about the ancient civilizations in the Eastern Hemisphere. They will explore and understand the geography of the Eastern Hemisphere. Students will explore the Neolithic Revolution and the importance of the Stone Age and prehistoric times. They will also analyze and explore the characteristics of the Ancient River Valley civilizations and the Classical Civilizations of the Eastern Hemisphere. Students also learn about the major world religions and the Middle Ages and its connection to the world, as well as the interactions made across the Eastern Hemisphere between explorers at the time.

Sample Student Schedule in 5th or 6th Grade

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
7:25-8:05	8:13-8:53	8:57-9:37	9:41-10:21	10:25-11:05	11:09-11:49	11:53-12:33	12:37-1:17	1:21-2:01
ISA Spanish 1a	Exploratory *	ELA		Lunch	ISA SS 5	Math 5	PE/Music	Science 5

* Art
* Computers
* Media
* Stem

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
7:25-8:05	8:13-8:53	8:57-9:37	9:41-10:21	10:25-11:05	11:09-11:49	11:53-12:33	12:37-1:17	1:21-2:01
ISA SS 6	PE/Music	Science 6	Math 6	Lunch	ELA		Art/Health	ISA Spanish 1B

6th Grade

ISA Spanish 1B	ISA Social Studies 6th
Students will continue to enhance reading, writing, listening, and speaking proficiency in Spanish through engaging activities. Students will explore age-appropriate texts, such as short stories, poems, and informational articles, to develop their reading comprehension and critical thinking skills. Writing tasks will include personal narratives, descriptive pieces, and short essays, with a focus on sentence structure, vocabulary, and grammar. Listening and speaking exercises will encourage active participation, collaborative discussions, and oral presentations to boost confidence in using Spanish in everyday situations. The course also incorporates cultural elements to inspire an appreciation for the diverse traditions and perspectives within the Spanish-speaking world.	Students in 6th grade integrate content while practicing their reading, writing, listening and speaking skills in Spanish. 6th grade social studies is all about the ancient civilizations in the Eastern Hemisphere. They will explore and understand the geography of the Eastern Hemisphere. Students will explore the Neolithic Revolution and the importance of the Stone Age and prehistoric times. They will also analyze and explore the characteristics of the Ancient River Valley civilizations and the Classical Civilizations of the Eastern Hemisphere. Students also learn about the major world religions and the Middle Ages and its connection to the world, as well as the interactions made across the Eastern Hemisphere between explorers at the time.

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ISA Spanish 1a	Exploratory *	ELA		Lunch	ISA SS 5	Math 5	PE/Music	Science 5

* Art
* Computers
* Media
* Stem

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
7:25-8:05	8:13-8:53	8:57-9:37	9:41-10:21	10:25-11:05	11:09-11:49	11:53-12:33	12:37-1:17	1:21-2:01
ISA SS 6	PE/Music	Science 6	Math 6	Lunch	ELA		Art/Health	ISA Spanish 1B

7th Grade

Spanish 2	Spanish Language Arts 7 (SLA)
In this class, students will become actively engaged in meaningful and authentic uses of the Spanish language. They will develop a variety of skills that will allow them to use Spanish in a myriad of authentic situations. Specifically, students will use the following modes of communication: ●Interpretive Mode = Comprehend reading and listening materials in Spanish ●Interpersonal Mode = Engage in conversations with speakers of Spanish Presentational Mode = Present information and ideas in both written and spoken formats of Spanish.	In this course students will dig deep into the difference and similarities between the English Language and Spanish Language in both written and spoken formats. Work on reading and writing strategies with the use of short novels.Students will become bilingual, biliterate, and culturally literate in this ever-increasing global society. Our students will achieve academic excellence in two languages while attaining a multicultural understanding and appreciation for the different cultures represented in our program and in our world. ***This is a required course for the ISA dual language program.***

8th Grade

Spanish 3	Spanish Language Arts 8
This International Spanish Academy dual language advanced Spanish course prepares students for NYS Education Department's Checkpoint B proficiency exam as well as the DELE A2/B1 Escolar.Expanding on vocabulary and increasing an understanding of more complicated verb forms and grammatical concepts will allow students to communicate more effectively and understand the target language in authentic situations. Topics include personal identification, family life, education, house and home, leisure, shopping, community neighborhood, meal taking/food/drink, physical environment, travel, health and welfare, earning a living, public and private services, services and repairs, and current events. Students are required to take the Checkpoint B proficiency exam at the conclusion of this course.	This course has been designed to enhance students' proficiency in Spanish through the development of critical language skills: reading, writing, listening, and speaking. Students will explore a variety of texts, including literary works, informational articles, and multimedia resources, to strengthen their reading comprehension and analytical abilities. Writing assignments will focus on creative expression, persuasive techniques, and academic essay construction, with an emphasis on grammar and vocabulary development. Listening and speaking activities will provide opportunities to engage in meaningful conversations, present ideas, and develop oral fluency in diverse contexts. This is a required course for the ISA dual language program.

*__DELE A2/B1:__ An internationally recognized assessment used to measure and certify students' Spanish language proficiency levels that is given to students in 8th grade.

Literacy Support Grades 5 through 8: Students may be offered an HLA course in lieu of the SLA course on the grade level in order to provide more intensive literacy support.

Home Language Arts (HLA)	
Grades 5-6	**Grades 7-8**
This course focuses on language and literacy development in a student's home language, Spanish. It includes the teaching and learning of reading, writing, speaking, and listening. It is designed for newcomer ELL students who require intensive literacy support in their home language. Instruction is provided to build foundational literacy skills in Spanish.	

Sample Student Schedule in 7th or 8th Grade

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
7:25-8:05	8:13-8:53	8:57-9:37	9:41-10:21	10:25-11:05	11:09-11:49	11:53-12:33	12:37-1:17	1:21-2:01
Social Studies	ISA SLA 7	Technology	PE/Music	ISA Spanish 2A	Lunch	ELA 7	Science 7	Math 7

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
7:25-8:05	8:13-8:53	8:57-9:37	9:41-10:21	10:25-11:05	11:09-11:49	11:53-12:33	12:37-1:17	1:21-2:01
Social Studies	ISA Spanish 3	Home & Careers	ELA	Algebra	Biology	Lunch	ISA SLA 8	PE/Music

Language Allocation- Southampton High School Model

DELE: DIPLOMA IN SPANISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE

Southampton High School has been recognized by the Spanish Embassy's Ministry as an International Spanish Academy (ISA). In order to be recognized as an International Spanish Academy, the school must demonstrate excellence in Spanish language instruction. To be eligible for the Diploma in Spanish as a Foreign Language granted by Instituto Cervantes on behalf of the Ministry of Education of Spain, students must be taught in Spanish for a minimum of two periods per day (25% of students' instructional day) throughout their four years of high school.

9th	ISA Hispanic Culture I	ISA Spanish 4H
10th	ISA Hispanic Culture II	ISA Spanish 5H
11th	ISA Hispanic Culture III	AP Language & Culture ISA
12th	AP Spanish Literature & Culture ISA (2 credits)	

Upon successful completion of each school, students will receive a certificate issued by the Spanish Ministry of Education that validates the student's completion of the corresponding cycle of a bilingual program in an International Spanish Academy.

SPANISH

Spanish 1 Grades 9-12; Proficiency Exam** 1 credit

In this course students will become actively engaged in meaningful and authentic uses of the Spanish language. They will develop a variety of skills that will allow them to use Spanish in a myriad of authentic situations. Specifically, students will use the following modes of communication: Interpretive Mode = Comprehend reading and listening materials in Spanish, Interpersonal Mode = Engage in conversations with speakers of Spanish, Presentational Mode = Present information and ideas in both written and spoken formats of Spanish. In addition, cultural information is woven throughout this course in order to expose students to the people, geographical locations, food, music and other cultural aspects of the Spanish-speaking world. (**Locally-developed Proficiency Examination as the final exam in June). (NCAA-Approved)

Spanish 2 Grades 9-12 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 1

This course builds upon skills developed in Spanish I, extending students' ability to understand and express themselves in Spanish and increasing their vocabulary. Typically, students learn how to engage in discourse for informative or social purposes, write expressions or passages that show understanding of sentence construction and the rules of grammar and comprehend the language when spoken slowly. Students usually explore the customs, history and art forms of Spanish-speaking people to deepen their understanding of the culture(s). (NCAA-Approved)

Spanish 3 Grades 9-12; Regents Exam** 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 2

This course focuses on having students express increasingly complex concepts both verbally and in writing while showing some spontaneity. Comprehension goals for students may include attaining increasing facility and understanding when listening to the language spoken at normal rates, being able to paraphrase or summarize written passages, and conversing easily within limited situations. Students are required to take the Spanish **Locally-developed Regents-Like exam in June. (NCAA-Approved)

Spanish 4H Grades 10-12 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 3(or demonstrated language proficiency)

This course focuses on advancing students' skills and abilities to read, write, speak, and understand the Spanish language so that they can maintain simple conversations with sufficient vocabulary and an acceptable accent, have sufficient comprehension to understand speech spoken at a normal pace, read uncomplicated but authentic prose and write narratives that indicate a good understanding of grammar and a strong vocabulary. This course may be offered in conjunction with a college. If college credit is desired, students will pay a reduced tuition to that college. Please consult with the teacher to determine readiness for success and with the school counselor to assess academic plans. (NCAA-Approved)

Spanish 5H Grades 11-12 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 4 (or demonstrated language proficiency)

This course extends students' facility with the language so that they are able to understand, initiate and sustain general conversations on topics beyond basic survival needs. Reading and writing tasks will usually include all normal verb tenses (present, past, and future). This course may be offered in conjunction with a college. If college credit is desired, students will pay a reduced tuition to that college. Please consult with the teacher to determine readiness for success and with the school counselor to assess academic plans. (NCAA-Approved)

ISA Spanish 4H Grades 9-12 1 credit

Prerequisites: Spanish 3 (or demonstrated language proficiency)

This course is designed to enhance and further develop the writing, reading, listening and speaking of bilingual and/or native speakers of Spanish. Coursework is taught in Spanish and aims to build a student's knowledge of literary movements while developing their own appreciation and enjoyment of the many facets of Spanish in their own lives. This course may be offered in conjunction with a college.If college credit is desired, students will pay a reduced tuition to that college. Additionally, students may consider registering (Feb-March) through College Board for an SAT Subject test in Spanish in May or June.Please consult with the teacher to determine readiness for success and with the school counselor to assess academic plans. (NCAA-Approved)

ISA Hispanic Culture I: The Culture of the Spanish Language and its Peoples Grades 9-12 1 credit

Prerequisites: Spanish 3 (or demonstrated language proficiency)

This course, taught in Spanish, is designed for students to reflect upon the products, practices, and perspectives of the varying cultures of Spanish speakers from across the world.Some of the significant Hispanic artists and writers who have made rich and diverse cultural contributions will be highlighted. Through the use of authentic resources the coursework aims to provide its students with a historical and linguistic framework of Spanish and its place in the 21st century. (NCAA-Approved)

SISA Spanish 5H Grades 10-12 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 4 (or demonstrated language proficiency)
This course is taught in Spanish and is designed to introduce a representative body of literature and historical texts, written in Spanish from Spain, Latin America and the United States. A critical analysis of literature from within particular historical events is outlined in its units of study. The units are developed in conjunction with the Spanish Film class and aim to build each student's historical and cultural understandings for a broader analysis of prose, poetry and drama from within different geopolitical and historical periods. This course may be offered in conjunction with a college. If college credit is desired, students will pay a reduced tuition to that college. Please consult with the teacher to determine readiness for success and with the school counselor to assess academic plans. (NCAA-Approved)

ISA Hispanic Culture II: Iberian and Central American Civilization, Culture and Literature Grades 10-12 1 credit

Prerequisites: Successful completion of Hispanic Culture I This course studies the evolution of the culture and civilization of the Iberian Peninsula and Central America as seen through its: art, cinema, music, architecture and literature. A special emphasis is given to the literary analysis of Spanish and Latin American poetry and prose from within its social, political and historical framework.(NCAA-Approved)

DELE A2/B1 or B2/C1 Escolar: *An internationally recognized assessment used to measure and certify students' Spanish language proficiency levels. If students did not take the DELE A2/B1 in 8th grade they take it in 10th Grade and B2/C1 in 11th grade.*

AP Spanish Language ISA Grade 11-12; AP Exam 1 credit

Prerequisite: Spanish 5 H or ISA Spanish 5 H
Designed by the College Board to parallel third-year college-level courses in Spanish Composition and Conversation, this course builds upon prior knowledge and develops students' ability to understand others and express themselves (in Spanish) accurately, coherently, and fluently in both formal and informal situations. Students will develop a vocabulary large enough to understand literary texts, magazine/newspaper articles, films and television productions, and so on. Enrolled students are required to take the Spanish Language Advanced Placement examination in May. Please consult with the teacher to determine readiness for success and with the school counselor to assess academic plans.(NCAA-Approved)

ISA Hispanic Culture III: Spanish and South American Civilization, Culture and Literature Grades 11-12 1 credit

Prerequisites: Successful completion of Hispanic Culture II (or demonstrated language proficiency)This course studies the evolution of the culture and civilization of South America as seen through its: art, cinema, music, architecture and literature. The studies are aimed at developing the student's analysis of poetry, short stories and novels in relation with the culture of their country and its relevance in the international setting. The thematic structure of this course is composed of the study of regional literature, avant-garde Latin American poetry, the Latin American boom and the post-boom literature. (NCAA-Approved)

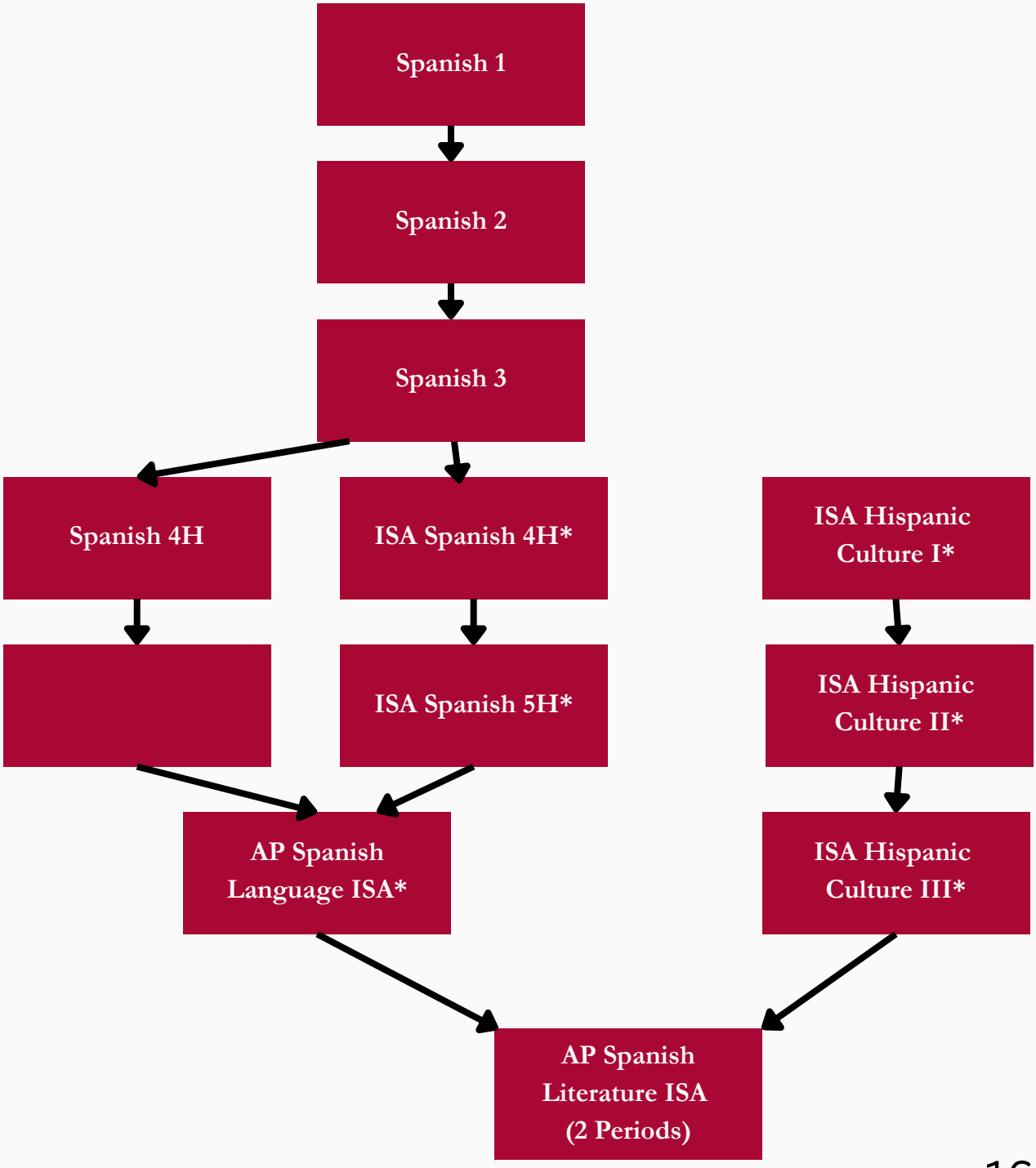
AP Spanish Literature ISA Grade 12; AP Exam 2 credits

Prerequisite: AP Spanish Language and Hispanic Culture III (or demonstrated language proficiency)
The AP Spanish Literature and Culture course is designed to develop student's critical reading and analytical writing skills. The course will present the representative texts (short stories, novels, poetry, and essays) from Peninsular Spanish, Latin American, and United States Hispanic literature. Only unabridged, full text, Spanish language versions of the required 38 readings will be used in class. Literature is examined within the context of its time and place, as students reflect on the many voices and cultures present in the required readings. This course is a double period to provide the student with the opportunity to explore cultural connections and comparisons through various media (e.g., art, film, articles, literary criticism). (Note: This course meets two periods each day). Enrolled students are required to take the Spanish Literature Advanced Placement examination in May.

LANGUAGES STUDIED AT OTHER ACCREDITED EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

Students who have participated in a language program (not offered at SHS, such as Polish, Lithuanian, etc.) through an accredited educational institution may apply to transfer credit(s) to SHS. The student must provide official documentation of the hours of instruction and level of proficiency to the building principal for evaluation toward awarding of credit.

Southampton Spanish Pathways



***Students must enroll in the required courses (2 periods = 25% of instructional day) each year for International Spanish Academy (ISA) diploma eligibility**

SOUTHAMPTON
UNION FREE SCHOOL DISTRICT

Enrollment in the Dual Language Program

- Families may opt their child into the Dual Language program during Kindergarten Registration
- If a student enters Southampton in grades 1-4, they may take an entrance exam for admission into the Dual Language program
- Students who are transferring into the district and have been enrolled in a Dual Language Program in a previous district will be granted immediate entrance
- English Language Learning students who require Language Proficiency services may automatically be entered into the Dual Language Program

The Process for Identifying English Language Learners

ENROLLMENT

Upon registration to the district all parents will be provided with a "Home Language Questionnaire."

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HOME LANGUAGE QUESTIONNAIRE

If the Home Language Questionnaire states that a language other than English is spoken in the home, the student will receive an initial screening by the Multilingual Dept.

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INITIAL ASSESSMENT

The Dept of Multilingual will administer the WIDA(World-Class Instructional Design and Assessment). The assessment is sent to the state of education department for scoring and student will score at the Entering, Emerging, Transitioning or Expanding level and is identified as a LEP. If a student scores at the Commanding level, he will not be identified as an ELL student.

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PROGRAM PLACEMENT/ANNUAL ASSESSMENT

Every Spring all ELL students will take the WIDA(World-Class Instructional Design and Assessment) to determine their level of English Proficiency for the following school year. Services to ELL students are provided according to their level of proficiency.

Commitment

- By opting into the Dual Language Program, families are making a long-term commitment for their child to participate in the Dual Language program throughout their school career. This commitment supports program consistency and allows students to fully develop bilingualism and biliteracy over time.
- Exiting the Dual Language program will result in a classroom change.
- When opting in or out, that commitment is for one full year.

Family Commitment

The Dual Language Program is systematic in nature. The effects of education are cumulative and the full benefits are only evident over the long term of the enriched educational experience. It is important for families to commit to the program throughout the school year. Active parent involvement in the program is required to sign a commitment agreement. Families are essential partners in our Dual Language Immersion program. Research shows that long-term family involvement is critical to program success. When parents engage consistently and value bilingualism, children are more likely to thrive academically, socially, and culturally. This is a long-term journey, and the full benefits of bilingualism and biliteracy become evident over time. (Cloud, Genesee & Hamayan, 2000; Arlington Public Schools, 2023) Hence, parents of students in the program will be required to sign a commitment agreement and commit to the program.

How can parents help their child at home?

Families play a vital role in a child's success in a Dual Language Program. You do not need to speak both languages to support your child.

- Ways families can help at home:
- Encourage reading in any language
- Talk with your child about their school day
- Ask your child to explain what they are learning
- Celebrate bilingualism and cultural identity
- Provide opportunities for meaningful conversation
- Attend Parent workshops on supporting your Dual Language child(ren) at home offered by the District

The most important support you can offer is fostering a positive attitude toward learning and language.

Frequently Asked Questions

Will my child be confused about learning in two languages?

No. Research shows that children are capable of learning multiple languages and that skills transfer between languages over time.

What if my child is stronger in one language?

This is normal. Language development varies, and the program is designed to support growth in both languages over time.

How long does it take to become bilingual and biliterate?

Bilingualism and biliteracy develop gradually, usually taking up to 7 years. Consistent participation in the program through elementary school supports long-term success.

Criteria for Admission and Retention:

Admission to the program begins with attending an information session prior to Kindergarten and submission of a signed commitment letter. Decisions regarding admission after Kindergarten, placement, and continued participation in the program are made on an individualized basis and take into consideration each student's unique academic, linguistic, social-emotional, and educational needs. Ongoing participation is reviewed collaboratively to ensure that the program continues to support the student's growth and success.

Written testimonials? DL Alumni Survey Link

Our Commitment

We are committed to creating an inclusive, supportive environment where students thrive academically, linguistically, and culturally. Our Dual Language Program values every child's background and views bilingualism and biculturalism as a lifelong gift. We look forward to partnering with families on this exciting journey.

For questions or additional information, please contact the Director of Multilingual and Culturally Responsive Education 631-591-4517.

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